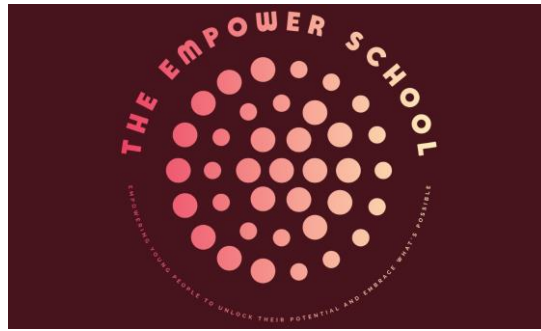


The Empower School
Curriculum Policy



Curriculum Policy

For

The Empower School Ltd

This Policy is available on our website.

This Policy is available on our website and is available on request from the referring school office. We also inform parents and carers about this policy when their children join our school via school referral.

This policy will be reviewed in full by The Empower School Ltd on an annual basis. This policy was last reviewed and agreed by the Directors of The Empower School Ltd on 20th January 2025. It is due for review on 20th January 2026.

Signature

Director

Date:

Signature

Director

Date:

1. Policy Statement

The Empower School is committed to delivering a high-quality, inclusive curriculum designed to meet the diverse needs of students facing barriers to mainstream

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education. Our curriculum supports academic achievement, personal development, and the skills necessary for progression into further education and training.

Our academic curriculum covers English, Maths, Science, IT, Geography, History, PE, Aesthetic and Creative subjects, and PSHE. Each term, students will complete an ASDAN (**Award Scheme Development and Accreditation Network**) award as part of a project-based learning approach. All projects will be delivered exclusively by staff at The Empower School at our main premises:

Premises Details: Poltimore House, Poltimore, Exeter EX4 0AU, UK

Additionally, Kip McGrath, an Ofsted-registered and approved provider, will offer weekly supplementary support in Maths and English. While they will not follow the national curriculum, they will provide targeted reinforcement for students needing extra support in these core subjects. These lessons will be delivered by Ofsted-registered tutors from Kip McGrath, with additional support from Empower School staff. This will be hired for our sole use during our time here.

Premises Details: Kip McGrath Exeter East, 45-47 Fore Street, Heavitree, Exeter, EX1 2QN

2. Aims of the Curriculum

The Empower School is a specialist institution dedicated to supporting students with Social, Emotional, and Mental Health (SEMH) needs. The core focus is on well-being, personal development, and academic achievement.

Our curriculum aims to:

- Deliver a broad, balanced, and engaging education suitable for students with SEND and SEMH needs.

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- ASDAN (Award Scheme Development and Accreditation Network) will form a key part of our curriculum, providing qualifications and learning programs designed to help students develop life skills, personal development, and vocational qualifications. Students will gain experience in the following subject areas through ASDAN via a project-based learning model: English, Maths, Science, IT, Geography, History, PE, Aesthetic and Creative, PSHE.

- PSHE is a non-statutory subject, but the government expects all schools to make provision for it. Alongside this education around Relationships, Health, and Sex Education (RHSE), ensures that the guidance complies with current statutory requirements for teaching these subjects within the curriculum.

- Forest School will be delivered also in this curriculum which will be embedded in our ASDAN curriculum each term with this serving to deliver experience in English, Maths, Science, IT, Geography, History, PE, Aesthetic and Creative, PSHE.

- Promote academic supplementation in GCSE core subjects (English and Maths).
- Foster resilience, confidence, and self-regulation to enable students to thrive in education and life.
- Provide opportunities for community engagement and experiential learning.
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3. Curriculum Principles

- Personalisation: Tailored programs to meet the individual needs of each student.
- Inclusivity: Accessible curriculum for all learners, including those with EHCPs.
- Holistic Development: Focus on academic, emotional, and life skills.
- Community Integration: Emphasis on collaboration with local schools, parents, and community projects.

- Career Development: Opportunities for guest speakers, workplace visits, and partnerships with further education institutions.

4. Curriculum Structure

4.1 Core Subjects:

- English: Focus on supplemented aid in literacy, reading comprehension, and communication skills.
- Mathematics: Focus on supplemented aid in development of numeracy, problem-solving, and critical thinking.

4.2 ASDAN Integrated Subjects:

- English, Maths, Science, IT, Geography/History, PE, Aesthetic and Creative, and PSHE are delivered via ASDAN programs:
 - Environmental Award: Activities focused on sustainability, renewable energy, and recycling: <https://www.asdan.org.uk/environmental-short-course/>
 - Personal Development Programme: Community engagement and local history research for personal growth: <https://www.asdan.org.uk/personal-development-programmes>
 - Enterprise Award: Encouraging creativity, innovation, and entrepreneurial skills: <https://www.asdan.org.uk/courses/enterprise-short-course/>

4.3 Personal Development:

- SEMH Support: Daily mentoring for emotional resilience and self-regulation.
- Life Skills: Practical skills for independence and social interaction.
- PSHE: Focused on personal, social, health, and economic education.

4.4 Enrichment Activities:

- Outdoor Learning: Engagement in Poltimore House and other green spaces, delivered within our Forest School programme.

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- **Community Projects:** Activities fostering teamwork and a sense of purpose.

5. Curriculum Delivery

- **Teaching Methods:** A mix of project-based learning, structured lessons, experiential learning, and mentoring.
- **Small Class Sizes:** Ensuring individualised attention and support.
- **SEND-Specific Strategies:** Specialist support for students with EHCPs.
- **Tutoring Partnerships:** Collaboration with Kip McGrath for English and Maths supplemented aid.

6. Assessment and Monitoring

- **Baseline Assessments:** Conducted upon entry to identify areas for improvement.
- **Ongoing Assessment:** Regular reviews of academic progress, emotional development, and life skills.
- **Reporting:** Weekly updates to schools, parents, and carers.
 - Learner Voice

Termly assessments

- Learning trackers for ongoing development

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- Weekly student reflections and feedback on their learning experiences, ensuring their input is integrated into ongoing curriculum planning.

7. Equal Opportunities

- The curriculum promotes equality and diversity, ensuring all students have access to learning opportunities regardless of their background or ability.

8. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually to ensure alignment with statutory requirements and the needs of our students.

Signed:

Position:

Date: